

Empire of AI is wildly misleading on AI water use

Posted by u/-mickomoo- • 0 points • 43 comments

Not endorsing this but I stepped onto ex-Twitter for a sec to check a DM from an old follower and saw EAs were attacking Hao's book mainly over the language used to communicate water use in Chile. Hao for her part handled this well and is checking with the source of the citation.

This same person also wrote posts criticizing general media coverage on data center water use and also wrote an article specifically on More Perfect Union's coverage.

Comments

u/obelix_dogmatix • 1 points • 2026-04-08 21:26 UTC

Thankfully ... that irresponsible person has owned up to the data error. There was an error in unit. This kind of an error would have nullified my thesis, but Karen still has her inaccurate misinformed book in wide circulation.

u/quetzal1234 • 11 points • 2025-11-21 04:11 UTC

I actually don't think it necessarily matters that much to the overall point the book was making? It's mostly about how AI is an extractive technology that leaves most people worse off in a bunch of ways. One point being wrong doesn't change the overall argument.

there was also recent reporting in the US about large data centers causing taps to run dry, so apparently it can happen.

u/ertri • 0 points • 2025-11-21 16:03 UTC

No, but like making any opposition argument, you should focus on the facts and actual reasons to oppose it. Which there are enough of to build a good case without having to exaggerate

u/quetzal1234 • 1 points • 2025-11-22 03:02 UTC

I agree, but I don't think it was a lie, I think it was a mistake which does happen. I was just trying to point out that I still think the overall argument is sound.

u/ertri • 0 points • 2025-11-22 03:03 UTC

Yeah, not a lie; but still important to be correct in criticisms